The Global Regulation–to–Action Atlas

The free edition: every major AI governance regime in the world, verified, on one map

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Abbreviations and Acronyms

No prior knowledge is assumed. Every acronym used in this document is spelled out below.

- **AI:** artificial intelligence.
- **EU AI Act:** the European Union Artificial Intelligence Act, Regulation (EU) 2024/1689.
- **LGPD:** Lei Geral de Protecao de Dados, Brazil's General Data Protection Law, Law 13.709/2018.
- **ISO/IEC 42001:** the AI management system standard published by the International Organization for Standardization and the International Electrotechnical Commission in December 2023.
- **NIST AI RMF:** the Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Framework of the United States National Institute of Standards and Technology.
- **OECD:** the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development.
- **UNESCO:** the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization.
- **ASEAN:** the Association of Southeast Asian Nations.
- **AU:** the African Union.
- **UAE:** the United Arab Emirates.
- **PDPC:** Singapore's Personal Data Protection Commission.
- **METI:** Japan's Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry.
- **SDAIA:** the Saudi Data and Artificial Intelligence Authority.

Why this atlas exists

Most artificial intelligence governance guidance is written as if every organization answered to Brussels or Washington. It does not. Your obligations may be written in Brasilia, Lima, Nairobi, Singapore, Seoul, or Abu Dhabi, and they are moving fast. This atlas puts every major regime on one map, so that an organization anywhere, from a three-person team to a national ministry, can see what applies to it and what to do first.

How to read this atlas

Each entry names the instrument, its legal status with the date it was verified, what it asks of you, and the first action to take. Three disciplines govern every entry. First, every status is verified as of the second quarter of 2026, and regulation moves, which is why the atlas is refreshed quarterly. Second, this atlas is governance guidance, not legal advice in any jurisdiction. Third, where a regime is a draft or a national strategy rather than binding law, the entry says so plainly.

Europe: the regime the world is converging on

- **The EU AI Act, Regulation (EU) 2024/1689:** Status: in force, with obligations phasing in on published dates (verified Q2 2026). It classifies systems into four risk tiers and provides administrative fines of up to 35 million euros or 7 percent of worldwide annual turnover for prohibited practices. Its AI literacy obligation applies since February 2025. First action: classify every system with the free EU AI Act quick classification, then document conformity with the EU AI Act Compliance Pack.

Latin America and Brazil

- **Brazil, Bill PL 2338/2023:** Status: approved by the Federal Senate in December 2024 and now before the Chamber of Deputies; advancing, not yet law (verified Q2 2026). A comprehensive risk-based bill deliberately aligned with the European tier logic. First action: inventory and classify your systems by risk now, because the Brazilian tiers mirror the European ones your instruments already serve.
- **Brazil, the LGPD, Law 13.709/2018:** Status: in force (verified Q2 2026). Brazil's data protection law already governs automated decision-making, including review rights over automated decisions. First action: run the AI Use-Case Intake Form on every system that touches personal data.
- **Peru, Law 31814 of 2023:** Status: in force, the first national AI law in Latin America (verified Q2 2026). A promotion-and-principles law that signals where enforcement will follow. First action: the Governance Readiness Scorecard.
- **Chile, Colombia, and Mexico:** Status: national strategies and draft bills in progress, most following the risk-based pattern (verified Q2 2026). First action: govern against the convergent core now, so that whichever bill lands first, you are already compliant in substance.

Africa

- **The AU Continental AI Strategy:** Status: adopted in July 2024, the umbrella framework for all 55 member states (verified Q2 2026). First action: the Governance Readiness Scorecard, aligned to the strategy's capability pillars.
- **Nigeria, Kenya, and Rwanda:** Status: Nigeria's National AI Strategy (2024), Kenya's National AI Strategy 2025 to 2030, and Rwanda's National AI Policy (2023) are adopted national strategies, not yet binding statutes (verified Q2 2026). First action: the AI Literacy Quick-Check and the Readiness Scorecard, because strategy-to-implementation is precisely where these markets stand, and where the advantage is won.

Asia-Pacific

- **Singapore:** Status: the PDPC Model AI Governance Framework, its generative AI edition (2024), and AI Verify, the first government-backed AI testing toolkit; voluntary but the region's de facto practice standard (verified Q2 2026). First action: the AI Governance Health Score, which maps naturally onto Singapore's testable-governance philosophy.
- **South Korea, the AI Basic Act:** Status: enacted in December 2024 and in force since January 2026, the world's second comprehensive AI law (verified Q2 2026). First action: risk classification and human-oversight documentation, using the Human-in-the-Loop Decision Guide.

- **Japan:** Status: a soft-law approach through the METI AI Guidelines for Business, alongside a light-touch AI promotion law of 2025 (verified Q2 2026). First action: the Responsible AI Principles, adopted as internal policy.
- **China:** Status: binding rules in force, including the Interim Measures for Generative AI (2023) and the algorithm recommendation and deep synthesis regulations (verified Q2 2026). First action: the AI Transparency Disclosure Builder, since labeling and disclosure duties sit at the center of the Chinese regime.
- **ASEAN:** Status: the Guide on AI Governance and Ethics (2024) covering the bloc, including Thailand and the Philippines; voluntary (verified Q2 2026). First action: the Governance Readiness Scorecard.
- **Australia:** Status: the Voluntary AI Safety Standard, with mandatory guardrails for high-risk settings proposed (verified Q2 2026). First action: the AI Risk Quick-Screen against the standard's ten guardrails.

The Middle East

- **The UAE:** Status: the National AI Strategy 2031 and the world's first Minister of State for AI; strategy-led, procurement-enforced (verified Q2 2026). First action: the Board and Executive Governance Pack, because in strategy-led regimes, governance is proven at the leadership table.
- **Saudi Arabia:** Status: the SDAIA AI ethics principles; national-authority guidance (verified Q2 2026). First action: the AI Ethics Self-Assessment, mapped to the SDAIA principles.

The global connective tissue

- **The OECD AI Principles:** updated in 2024, the reference point most national strategies cite (verified Q2 2026).
- **The UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of AI:** adopted in 2021 by more than 190 countries, and the instrument most African and Latin American governments cite (verified Q2 2026).
- **The Council of Europe Framework Convention on AI:** opened in 2024, the first binding international treaty on AI (verified Q2 2026).
- **ISO/IEC 42001 and the NIST AI RMF:** the certifiable management standard (December 2023) and the four-function method (Govern, Map, Measure, Manage) that regimes worldwide borrow from (verified Q2 2026).

These five are the crosswalk backbone. Govern once against them, and most national regimes are largely satisfied in substance.

The pattern this map reveals

Read together, the regimes converge on four demands: risk-based classification, human oversight, transparency, and documented accountability. The strategic consequence is powerful. An organization that governs once against the convergent core, then localizes at the edges, is substantially ready everywhere, from Sao Paulo to Seoul. That localization, obligation by obligation and instrument by instrument, is exactly what the full atlas does.

Where the free edition stops

This free edition gives you the WHAT and the WHY: every major regime, its verified status, and the first action. The full Global Regulation-to-Action Atlas, part of the paid catalog, maps each regime obligation by obligation to the specific AI GOVERNANCE CHAIN™ instrument that satisfies it, right-sized from a three-person team to a national ministry, and is kept current by the quarterly Regulatory Update Service. This atlas also feeds CHAINGUIDE™, the disagreement engine, so a visitor in Bogota, Dakar, or Manila can ask what applies to them and receive a cited answer.

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Human-first AI governance framework
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